

LASD Matters, Issue 1: Transparency and Consequences

Hello! I'm Vladimir Ivanovic, a former Los Altos School District (LASD) Board member. I resigned in March 2026 because I could not support the Board's decision to move 650 Bullis Charter School (BCS) students to a new campus to be built just for them on land that LASD acquired in 2019. I think it's the wrong decision for a multiple reasons that I'll go over in another issue of "LASD Matters".

For now, I want to highlight the Board's deliberate lack of transparency and two consequences of the Board's decision.

In November 2024, LASD voters passed Measure EE, a \$350M bond measure to upgrade LASD facilities. Strange as it may seem, the measure's legally required ballot summary didn't mention that 40% of the bond proceeds were to be used to give BCS the newest and best campus in all of LASD. This opacity was not accidental. Being upfront about how 40% of Measure EE was not going to benefit LASD schools would have sunk the bond measure. As it turns out, the measure barely passed with just a 1.2% margin, leaving LASD taxpayers on the hook to pay back an estimated \$730M over the next 30 years.

There are at least two serious consequences that have barely been discussed in public. One is that Measure EE will increase property taxes by ~\$600 to ~\$1200 or more per year until Measure EE is paid off – in 30 years. (The actual annual increase is \$30 per \$100,000 of assessed value. For a home assessed at \$2M, that \$600/year; for a \$4M home, that \$1200/year.)

Another consequence, not discussed at all, is the difficulty for LASD to pass two more bond measures that are needed to finance LASD upgrades and new construction. People, in general, don't like to be taken advantage of twice. In any case, the pass rate of bond measures in LASD has been dropping for years, and that will also make passing two more bond measures hard. So, once again, it's likely that LASD will not have enough money to upgrade its existing campuses nor to replace portables with permanent buildings, leaving BCS with LASD's only modern campus.

Visit the LASD Matters repository to find references, documentation, and discussions.

- Documentation and references:
<https://github.com/vgivanovic/vgivanovic.github.io/wiki>
- Discussions: <https://github.com/vgivanovic/vgivanovic.github.io/discussions>